Country Compliance Report:

Austria

Information class: Restricted

Country Compliance Report: Austria

Report operational:	27 July 2023
Author:	Mariana Fagundez
Approver:	Qamar Al Hkim

Content

Introduction and document purpose

Pagero Group builds the world's largest, open business network – so you can reach any business, anywhere in the world. No matter how many borders your operations may cross or how many systems you are connected to, we take care of the technical and regulatory requirements across your entire order-to-cash, purchase-to-pay and freight processes. We give you data accuracy and security, transparency and real-time visibility – through a single connection.

At Pagero Group, we believe that technology supports sustainability. That's why we are committed to helping businesses become 100% paperless, supporting resource efficiency, transparency and business continuity.

The main purpose of this country compliance report is to provide the reader with an in-depth analysis of the focus country's laws, regulations, and process with regards to e-invoicing and other trade documents. The analysis considers topics such as business requirements before switching to electronic invoices, e-document creation, e-document distribution, integrity and authenticity, and, finally, e-archiving.

This document guides how Pagero solutions support customers in the focus country to meet local regulations and serves as a supplement to Pagero General E-invoicing Process Description.

1. Terminology

This section outlines general and country-specific terminology for Austria, which will be used throughout the whole document.

Term	Explanation
Centralized e-invoicing	Where trading parties are required to transmit e-documents to a predetermine infrastructure normally owned or maintained by the state. The infrastructure acts as an exchange engine, conducting mandatory checks, before delivering the invoice to the target public receiver.
B2B	Business-to-Business is a transaction or business conducted between one business to another, such as a wholesaler and retailer
B2G	Business-to-Government refers to the business relationship a company selling products, services or information to governments or government agencies
B2C	Business-to-Consumer normally refers to the process of businesses selling products and services directly to consumers, with no middleman i.e. supplier to consumer.
BBG	*Ge. Bundesbeschaffung Gm*bH. is the Federal Procurement office in Austria
BRZ	Austrian Federal Computing Centre
e-Rechnung	Is the name of the platform to transmit electronic invoices to the federal government and to connected institutions of the other public sector. Federal Services Portal (Unternehmensserviceportal - USP). This platform allows the interchange of invoices in three ways: • The direct uploading of invoices • The manual creation of invoices through an online form • The “web service” connection or through an external provider
USP	Unternehmensserviceportal. Business service portal, where businesses must register to start sending e-invoices and fulfill other types of tax obligations.

USt	Umsatzsteuer (USt) or Mehrwertsteuer. Local VAT name in Austria.
Peppol Network	The Peppol Network is a logical network enabling secure and reliable exchange of Peppol Dataset Types between End Users via Peppol Service Providers.
Post Audit	The post-audit model allows trading partners to exchange e-documents as well as other transactional fiscal documents (including but not limited to invoices, further called “e-documents”) directly with each other, without any real-time or immediate controls performed by the tax office. Even though eDocument is allowed, there are no prescriptions as to in what format, infrastructure or how they should be issued or distributed. The tax audits are performed afterward.

2. General overview

This section provides an initial introduction into the local eInvoicing environment within Austria, including the types of local e-invoice regulations, go-to governmental and industry bodies, and whether multiple invoicing regimes, that is, varying regulatory requirements, exist for example by industry, business size, or other defining factors.

Item	Commentary
Authorities and other agencies relevant for e-invoicing	• Austrian Tax Authority as head of tax administration issues guidelines for a better understanding and execution of the "e-invoicing" • USP (Business service portal) • E-rechnung • Federal Ministry Republic of Austria Finance
Main applicable legislation in respect of e-invoice issuance, exchange, reception and retention	• Council Directive 2010/45/EU of 13 July 2010 amending Directive 2006/112/EC on the common system of value added tax as regards the rules on invoicing • §5 IKTKonG (IKT-Konsolidierungsgesetz) • §11 UStG 1994 (Umsatzsteuergesetz) • §212 UGB (Unternehmergesetzbuch) • §132 BAO (Bundesabgabenordnung) • Ordinance of the Federal Minister of Finance on the submission of e-invoices to federal agencies (e-Billing Ordinance)

3. E-Invoice status

When considering sending or receiving e-invoices two basic questions should be considered: is invoice equal to paper invoice from the legal perspective; and if there are any situations where e-Invoicing is mandatory for reception or transmission.

Item	Commentary
E-invoice status	• Allowed
Varying invoicing regimes[1]	• Yes
e-Invoicing model	• B2G: Centralized (for certain B2G scenarios) • B2B: Post-audit
e-Invoice definition[2]	• An electronic invoice is an invoice that is issued, sent, received and processed in a structured electronic format and contains at least the invoice features specified in Section 11 (1) UStG 1994 . The e-invoice is only recognized as an invoice if I&A are ensured (§2 I e-Rechnungsverordnung, §5 I 1, 2 UStG)
Scope of taxpayers the e-document mandate applies to	• Mandatory for Issuing: ○ B2G: According to (§ 5 IKTKonG, §3 II e-Rechnungsverordnung) ,from January 1st, 2014 the federal government only accepts **structured electronic invoices** for goods and services. The IKT Consolidation Act. In other words, all contracting partners of the federal government, including foreign contracting partners, must only submit structured electronic invoices for the provision of goods and services to government departments[1]. Such federal offices are all federal ministries and their subordinate

[1] It is possible that a business is required to send e-invoice in some scenarios, and send voluntarily in others
[2] Differing definitions may exist between different levels of government, or differing legislation, i.e. accounting law and IT law

	departments. Further federal offices are the parliament, the office of the president, the administrative court, the constitutional court, the ombudsmen's office and the court of auditors. The e-invoices do not have to be signed, but if they are, they will be accepted by the invoice receiver. ◦ Certain selected departments of the other public administration accept e-invoices without legal obligation. A list of these entities can be found here. • Mandatory for Receiving: B2G: EU Directive 2014/55/EU has required all public administration bodies in all member countries to accept e-invoices since April 18, 2019. With the provision of the federal solution procedure for other invoice recipients, the technical prerequisites for quick and easy implementation of this EU directive are already in place. However, this does not create an obligation for the contractual partner to transmit e-invoices to the other invoice recipients.
Mandatory AoR (document response) process	• N.a.
Implementation / roll-out plan	• Since the 1st of January 2014, it is mandatory to send electronic invoices to federal bodies (§7 IKTKonG)

4. Before switching to e-invoices

4.1. IT[3] registration

The following thresholds apply to the requirement to be registered for a IT number in Austria:

- Exemption for small businesses – EUR 35.000
- Application of the special scheme for acquisitions by taxable persons not entitled to deduct input tax and by non-taxable legal persons – EUR 10.000
- Application of the special scheme for distance selling – EUR 35.000

Please note that the thresholds stated above are not an exhaustive list of circumstances requiring local IT registration.

IT number format in Austria: AT U 12345678

4.2. Process to switch to e-Invoicing

Even though many countries encourage or even mandate e-Invoicing, there may be specific requirements on the Trading parties – typically the Supplier – before starting an e-Invoicing program. This section provides a brief overview of such requirements.

Item	Commentary
Actions towards authorities, required in order to enable electronic processing instead of conventional processing	• Register with USP is required (B2G) • In case, that e-invoices shall be submitted by other public administration offices to federal offices, it is necessary to integrate the functions of E-RECHNUNG.GV.AT into a public administration portal (PVP).
Actions between the trading partners, e.g. customer acceptance, agreement, etc.	• (B2B) Buyer's consent is required, the acceptance can occur by tacit agreement, e.g. by paying the invoice (§11 II 3 UStG)

[3] For the purpose of this document, IT refers to Indirect Tax, including, but not limited to Value-Added Tax (VAT), Goods and Sales Tax (GST), Sales tax, etc.

Transition period from the moment of starting e-invoicing during which, e.g. parallel invoicing may be allowed	• None

4.3. Outsourcing invoice issuance function

Many companies decide to outsource the issuance process of e-invoicing to third parties who have the necessary infrastructure and knowledge of implementing and executing e-Invoicing. This may be driven by a technical limitation or local regulatory requirements. However, before doing so, it is highly recommended that a supplier investigates whether such outsourcing is permissible and whether any requirements must be fulfilled.

Item	Commentary
Whether outsourcing of invoice issuance (creation) is allowed or not	• Allowed
Whether statement of outsourced issuance i required on the invoice	• Not explicitly required
Whether outsourcing agreement is required between the taxpayer and the third-party is performing actions on its behalf	• Agreement is required
Content and formality requirements to the Outsourcing agreement between the taxpayer and the third-party	• An e-invoice can be issued in the name and on behalf of the supplier. There are no content and formal requirements to the outsourcing agreement.
Whether any notifications to or derogations from authorities are required in the specific jurisdiction for outsourced issuance	• It is sufficient for the third party to register with the USP.
Whether, and which, requirements exist to the outsourced party to be able to act on behalf of the taxpayer	• No explicit requirements • A list of service providers connected to USP can be find here

4.4. Outsourcing invoice receipt function

Due to the unique nature of the AP process, it may be required for the buyer (invoice receiver) to have an explicit agreement, or other permissions to be put in place for Service Providers to conduct invoice receiving functions on behalf of them.

Austria has no explicit requirements on the outsourcing of the function of receiving invoices (similar to the function to issue invoices as outlined above).

5. Document processing

5.1. Format and other technical requirements

Globally, a multitude of e-Invoicing formats and infrastructures exist. Local regulators often offer or mandate the use of certain formats, standards, or platforms for the transmission or delivery of invoices or other tax-related documents. Pagero has the technical depth and experience to support country-specific technical requirements globally.

Item	B2G	B2B
Mandated document format(s) for exchange with mandated Gov platform(s) and/or between the trading parties	• ebInterface (several versions) • Peppol BIS, UBL (various versions)	• No explicit requirements
Other document format(s) commonly used for exchange between trading parties	• ebInterface • PEPPOL BIS	• XML • PDF • Text file (e.g. Word)
Mandated platform(s) required to have connection with for e-document processing	• USP (§5 II Nr. e-Rechnungsverordnung)	• None
Other platform(s) relevant for e-document processing	• None	• None
Schematron(s), XSD schema or other official mechanisms ensuring document content	• PEPPOL schematron	• N.a.

Routing ID's / codes or other identifiers used in the jurisdiction for counter-party identification and document exchange	• For Federal public bodies behind USP Peppol ParticipantID: 9915:b[4]	• e-mail • customer address •
Other technical aspects	• None	• None

5.2. Communication with USP

Regulations in Austria foresee the following options on how e-documents can be communicated with the mandatory infrastructure(s):

Communication options	Commentary
Automated	• Automatic transmission via USP WS or via Peppol SP
Manual	• USP portal, by keying or uploading an invoice
Other options	• None

5.3. Issuance and clearance process

This section describes the document issuance and clearance process from the supplier perspective.

5.3.1. Domestic documents

This section describes the process for documents created to be transmitted within the given country

B2G e-invoicing:

Sending invoices to the Federal government:

Austria mandates the use of the Federal Service Portal (Unternehmensserviceportal – USP), the central processing e-invoicing platform of the federal government to receive e-invoices. E-invoices are sent to the Austrian Federal Government through the Federal Service Portal. The portal is operated by the Federal Computing Centre (BRZ). A one-time free-of-charge registration step is necessary before eInvoices can be transmitted (source).

[4] Note: all invoice recipients have the same Peppol participant ID. The actual recipient will be determined from the order reference inside the document.

The Austrian federal government receives and processes eInvoices from economic operators supported by the following solutions:

- The Federal Government receives eInvoices created by means of a direct eInvoice upload, manual eInvoice creation via web-form or a web-service connection.
- The Federal Business Service Portal (USP) provides authentication services necessary for the submission of eInvoices and does not require further use of electronic signatures

(1) Supplier directly or through a sending service provider (SSP) provides e-document to USP
(2) USP sends the received e-document to the contracting authority
(3) Return communication from the contracting authority to the supplier is not common in Austria, i.a receipt acknowledgement, document approval or rejection, either directly or via SSP

Sending invoices to other governmental entities:

At sub-central level, the e-invoicing system is based on Peppol. The reception of e-invoices on a sub-central level is not organised by law. They are free to join eRechnung.gv.at, the federal government solution, as receivers voluntarily or implement their solution.

B2B e-invoicing

There are no explicit technical process requirements on e-invoices issuance in Austria, such as exchange with a predefined infrastructure, as B2B e-invoicing follows the post-audit model.

(1) Documents are exchanged between suppliers and customers in various formats and via various exchange mechanisms, due to legal requirements and other business-related preferences
(2) The key requirements are to ensure the country-specific document content, document integrity and authenticity, as well as archiving requirements
(3) Neither document format nor exchange mechanism are regulated

5.3.2. Cross-Border

This section describes the requirements for cross-border outbound documents such as sales invoices

Use of e-invoicing in the cross-border B2B scenario is not explicitly regulated in Austria. However, as mentioned above B2G foreign suppliers are mandated to send e-invoices to the federal government as mentioned in section 3.

5.4. Reception and validation process

This section describes the document reception, validation and acceptance processes from the buyer perspective.

5.4.1. Domestic documents

This section describes the process for documents received for purchases or transactions within the given country

This process is not explicitly regulated in Austria. Neither document format nor exchange mechanism are regulated as long as country-specific content is met.

5.4.2. Cross-Border

This section describes the requirements for cross-border inbound documents such as purchase invoices

Use of e-invoicing in the cross-border scenario is not explicitly regulated in Austria. Austrian buyer will usually receive a paper or PDF invoice for cross-border purchase invoices.

5.5. AoR (response) process

No explicit requirement to the Recipient to provide confirmation / notification to the Supplier that an e-Invoice has been received or approved.

5.6. USP validations

Some tax regimes require businesses to send tax documents to a predetermined hub either before, shortly after issuing invoices. Generally, a hub that requires this will send a reply to the issuer. This reply can be expressed as a clearance/ approval response, rejection, semi approved, etc.

Upon submission specific technical criteria (e.g. file format, mandatory fields, etc.) are validated. If the result is positive a registration confirmation is shown for invoices entered and uploaded in the online form. If a web service or PEPPOL interface is used a positive reply message will be sent immediately. In case of an error the system immediately gives negative feedback. In this case the eInvoice is considered as not submitted, no email is sent out and no web service call back is initiated.

After a positive technical validation the receiving system validates further prerequisites (e. g. correctness of the reference data regarding the order and the invoice recipient).

If the e-Invoice is correct both technically and content-wise, a PDF is generated and forwarded to the stated recipient. An email or web service call back with the PDF of the eInvoice attached informs the biller that the e-Invoice has been accepted.

If the content validation shows any errors, the biller is informed of the reasons by email or web service call back. In such cases, the invoice is considered as not submitted and no PDF is sent out.

5.7. Invoice presentation / copy

Some regimes require a visual presentation of the invoice file to be transmitted along with the structured invoice file. This section describes if there is any regulation concerning visual or image-based presentations of invoices as a copy for the original or vice versa.

To distinguish duplicate invoices from originals, the following wording must be used: "Duplicate" or “Copy" (UStR 2000, 1528).

Issuing a PDF Presentation (a human-readable duplicate) when Tax invoices are issued in machine-readable format files can be confusing. To ensure the correct management of original documents, in addition to technical controls, Pagero Online adds “Copy Tax Invoice” on PDF Presentations where Tax invoices have been issued as machine-readable format files.

5.8. Distribution between taxpayers

This section explains how and if trading parties can send invoices between each other. In some cases, hubs also distribute the tax document to the buyer.

Not regulated for B2B e-invoices, while for B2G e-invoices, esp. on the federal level, only via USP and Peppol.

Item	Commentary
Push communication	• No explicit requirements
Pull communication	• No explicit requirements
E-mail distribution	• B2B: Allowed • B2G: Not allowed
Webportal[5]	• B2B: Allowed via any third-party portal • B2G: Only via USP

5.9. Rectification process

This section will express the process that needs to be taken when there is an error in an invoice, how it is to be handled, and corrected by both buyer, seller, and if a notification needs to be delivered to the tax authority.

[5] Note, however, that prior to using and external portal, like Pagero’s Webportal, Suppliers are required to already have an invoice / invoice data in their internal accounting software. Portals are not designed for the purpose of replacing internal accounting but are a mechanism to make invoices available for the Buyer. Recommended only for businesses issuing fewer than 100 invoices annually.

Rectification process	
What are the options to correct an invoice if an incorrect IT rate, exemption or reverse charge is applied on the invoice	• Credit note • There is a possibility for the supplier to correct the invoice with a corrective invoice. The supplier has to issue the corrective invoice with a notification to the respective invoice • Legal authorization to correct: §16 I Nr.2 UStG; UStR 2000 Rz. 1735
What are the options to correct an invoice if the customer returns the goods	• Credit note/ Debit note • The debit note issued by the recipient has to fulfill the conditions in Connection with self-billing
What are the options to correct an invoice if the customer paid too much	• Other • In case that the customer paid too much erroneously the overpayment has to be paid back to the customer and no invoice correction is necessary.
What are the options to correct an invoice if the supplier agrees to a discount after the invoice was issued to the customer	• Credit note • Please note that there is no need to issue a credit note when the discount is granted because the payment has been made within a certain agreed deadline, we refer to the so-called "cash discounts"
What are the options to correct an invoice if the invoice misses data such as name, address, IT number, invoice reference, etc.	• Credit note • Corrective document (with a reference to the respective invoice)
Other scenarios with different correction option	• No
Party entitled to issue a credit note if the invoice was issued by the supplier (i.e. no self-billing)	• Supplier
Allowed to draft a 'waiting' document/interim document' in the absence of a purchase invoice and report IT as due and deductible on the basis of this document	• No • Only possible if reverse charge is applicable (no input VAT deduction for local input VAT in Austria without any purchase invoice).

5.10. Coexistence of paper and electronic invoices

Item	Commentary
Whether parallel invoicing (issuance and exchange of the same document in several formats, e.g. electronically and on paper) is	• There are no specific requirements, however, is recommended to be avoided

allowed and/or whether there are any regulations surrounding it	
Whether the jurisdiction allows for document (e.g. invoice) dematerialization, i.e. destruction of the original paper invoice, for processing and/or archiving	• Allowed
Whether any conditions apply, and which, to the dematerialisation	• if the integrity of the content and the readability is ensured.
Whether the jurisdiction allows for document (e.g. invoice) materialization, i.e. destruction of the original electronic document, for processing and/or archiving	• The eInvoice data can be deleted.
Whether any conditions apply, and which, to the materialisation	• The Austrian Fiscal code provides that this has to take place by guaranteeing a complete and ordered reproduction of the stored documents as well as the authenticity of their origin, the integrity of the content and their legibility throughout the storage period. It must be ensured that the scanned data cannot be modified, overwritten or altered in any way. Complete, structured, coextensive and accurate printout/retrieval (in "original manner") must be possible.

5.11. Contingency invoicing

This refers to the process for e-invoicing if any mandatory infrastructure is inaccessible. If temporary measures are available, or allowed, to facilitate invoicing during the downtime.

There are no specific prescriptions in this respect in Austria.

6. Document content requirements

6.1. Document types

Item	Commentary
Documents mandatory for issuance by supplier	• Complete invoice • Credit/Debit note/Rectification note
Documents mandatory for issuance by buyer	• No explicit requirement

Item	Commentary
Self-billing allowed	• Yes
Simplified invoice allowed	• In the B2B sector simplified invoices are allowed • Conditions: the order value must not exceed the threshold value of 400€ (§11 VI UStG)

6.2. Document numbering

This section outlines the requirements to the sequential numbering of invoices and, where applicable, other documents.

6.2.1. Document numbering by the taxpayer

Item	Commentary
A sequential number, based on one or more series, which uniquely identifies the invoice	• Yes (§11 I Nr.3 h UStG) • a sequential number with one or more series of numbers, which is assigned once to identify the invoice • Not required for invoices with a gross amount < EUR 400
Different series of sequential numbers allowed (e.g. a separate sequential	• Yes

numbering for intercompany billings, credit notes, etc.)	
Allowed to start a new sequential numbering every year	• Yes
Worldwide numbering on legal entity level allowed provided that gaps can be explained	• No, numbering required per registration • Please consider that in case of a foreign entrepreneur an individual accounting area is mandatory for domestic sales
Required that the numbers follow the date of issuance (i.e. is it true that an invoice with number 2 cannot have an invoice date older than the invoice with number 1)	• Yes

6.2.2. Additional document numbering

This section should outline any additional numbering, e.g. provided in addition by the tax authority or that must be generated by the taxpayer based on specific specifications.

Not applicable to Austria.

6.3. Indirect tax (IT)[6] rates

This section illustrates the applied IT[7] rates and provides a non-exhaustive list with examples of goods and/or services that fall within specific IT rates. IT rates that differ between different administrative units are clearly outlined.

Indirect tax rates		
20%	**Standard**	All other taxable goods and services.
13%	**Reduced**	Domestic flights; entrance to sporting events; admissions to cultural events and amusement parks; firewood; some agricultural supplies; wine production (from farm); cut flowers and plants for decorative use
10%	**Reduced**	Foodstuffs; take-away food; water supplies; pharmaceutical products; domestic transport (excluding flights); international and intra-community road and rail transport; newspapers and periodicals; printed books; e-books; pay and cable TV; TV licence; social services; domestic refuse collection; treatment of waste and waste water; restaurants (ex all beverages); cut flowers and plants for food production; some agricultural supplies; writers and composers
0%	**Zero**	Intra-community and international transport (excluding road and rail); hotel accommodation

[6] For the purpose of this document, IT refers to Indirect Tax, including, but not limited to Value-Added Tax (VAT), Goods and Sales Tax (GST), Sales tax, etc.
[7] Local name Umsatzsteuer (USt)

6.4. Mandatory IT invoice content

The section below illustrates the minimum legal requirements related to the content of invoices issued according primarily to the indirect tax regulations of Austria. Please note that other additional content requirements might apply in addition, i.a. of technical character.

General	
Required to mention the word "invoice"	• No, but recommended
Required that the invoice is issued in the language of the country who is entitled to impose the invoice requirements:	• No
Sequential numbering	• Yes, see section 6.2.1. above
Required to mention copy or duplicate in case a copy is issued	• Yes
Reference in case of outsourced issuance	• No explicit requirement

Supplier data	
Full legal name of the supplier	• Yes (§11 I Nr.1 lit. a UStG)
Allowed to abbreviate or shorten the legal name of the supplier	• Yes, provided the full legal name is mentioned as well
Full address of the supplier in country of establishment	• Yes (§11 I Nr.1 lit. a UStG)
Allowed to mention the PO box address instead of the legal address of the supplier	• No
IT identification number/sales tax number from the supplier in the country where the supply takes place for IT purposes	• Yes, if a registration is available in the country of supply (in Austria: §11 I Nr. 1 lit. i UStG)
IT identification number of the supplier in the country of establishment	• No • If transactions are performed in or from Austria by a non-resident business, generally the Austrian VAT ID number has to be stated. In this case, no further mentioning of the VAT ID number of the business in the country of establishment is required. However, in case of services of an EU-resident entrepreneur to an Austrian recipient that qualify as reverse charge service the VAT ID granted in the country of establishment of the EU supplier must be mentioned in the invoice (instead of an Austrian VAT ID number; No 1554 Austrian VAT guidelines).

Information (i.e. name, address, IT number) of the fiscal representative of the supplier (if appointed)	• No
Legal form of the supplier	• Yes (§14 I 1 UBG)
Trade register number of the supplier	• Yes • According to Commercial law provisions, (§14 I 1 UBG)
Company Registry data of the supplier (e.g. court registration, address of chamber of commerce)	• Yes • According to Commercial law provisions
Place of legal seat of the supplier (Headquarters)	• Yes • According to Commercial law provisions (§14 I 1 UBG)
Other supplier data	• B2G: the supplier number, which is given to the contractor by the federal administration (§4 I Nr.1 e-Rechnungsverordnung)

Customer data	
Full legal name of the customer	• Yes (§11 I Nr.3 lit. b UStG) • Not required for invoices with gross amount less than EUR 400 (§11 VI UStG) – B2B
Allowed to abbreviate or shorten the legal name of the customer	• Yes, provided the full legal name is mentioned as well
Address of the customer in country of establishment	• Yes • Not required for invoices with gross amount less than EUR 400 (§11 VI UStG) – B2B
Bill-to address when it is different from the registered address of the customer	• No
Allowed to address the invoice to a Post Office Box address instead of the legal address of the customer	• No
IT identification number in the country where the supply takes place for IT purposes in case of domestic supplies (if available)	• Yes • In general no. However, the VAT number has to be expressed provided that the invoice's gross amount exceeds EUR 10.000 and the supplier has the seat, his habitual abode or his permanent establishment in Austria (§11 I Nr.3 lit. b UStG). Furthermore, the VAT identification/sales tax number of the customer has to be shown on the invoice when the customer is liable to pay VAT on

	goods supplied or Services rendered to him.
IT identification number of the customer in the country of dispatch for invoices issued for exempt export supplies	• No
IT identification number of the customer in another Member than the Member State of dispatch for intra-Community supplies	• Yes
Information (i.e. name, address, IT identification number) of the fiscal representative (if customer has appointed a fiscal representative)	• No
Other customer data	• No

Transaction data	
Date of issue	• Yes (§11 I Nr.3 lit. g UStG)
Date of supply (chargeable event)	• Yes, but only if it differs from the invoice date. If it is the same date following Notation has to be mentioned: "Invoice date is the date of supply/service."
Date of prepayment	• No
Description of the goods/services	• Yes • Detailed descriptions of the goods/services are required, not only collective terms (§11 I Nr.3 lit. c UStG)
Quantity of the goods supplied or the extent of the services supplied	• Yes (§11 I Nr.3 lit. c UStG)
Purchase order number	• No, but recommended
Shipped from location (for the supply of goods)	• No, but recommended • Especially in case of cross-border transactions
Shipped to location (for the supply of goods)	• No, but recommended • Especially in case of cross-border transactions
Status of the goods (e.g. in bond, in free circulation)	• No, but recommended • Especially in case of cross-border transactions
Incoterms	• No, but recommended • Especially in case of cross-border transactions
Other information on the supplied goods/services required (except in case of intra-Community supply of new means of transport)	• No

Financial data	
Taxable base per item (unit price excl. IT)	• No • It is sufficient to indicate the total net amount per each VAT rate (§11 I Nr.3 lit. f UStG)
Total taxable base per IT rate or exemption	• Yes
IT rate applied	• Yes
Total IT amount calculated per rate	• Yes
Total IT amount payable	• Yes
Discounts/rebates if not included in the unit price	• Yes
Total gross amount (including IT)	• Yes
Mandatory to mention the total IT amount due in the national currency	• Yes • In case of an invoice in a foreign currency, the total VAT amount has to be stated in EUR as well. In case the EUR-amount is not certain at the time of issuance, the invoice-issuer has to state which conversion method according to §20 VI UStG will be applied. (§11 I Nr.3 lit. f UStG)
Which other amounts (i.e. none, only the total IT amount) must be mentioned in the national currency of your country	• None
Exchange rate (if the invoice is not issued in the local currency)	• Yes. Only in case the EUR VAT amount is not stated on the invoice.
Which exchange rate must be applied in order of priority	• The Austrian Ministry of Finance for the respective period; or • The current exchange rates by the European Central Bank. • Alternatively, the taxable person is allowed to use any other daily exchange rate for converting purposes, in case the rates can be proved by bank notifications or rate sheets.
Terms of payment	• No, but recommended • Required B2G (4 I Nr.5 e-Rechnungsverordnung)
IBAN and BIC number of supplier	• No, but recommended • Required B2G (§1 I Nr. 4 e-Rechnungsverordnung)

Specific references for invoices	
Invoice reference in case of IT exemption or reverse charge	• Yes (§19 I 2 UStG)

List the required references in case of exemption or reverse charge	• Local reverse Charge for non-established companies and the beneficiary is an entrepreneur within the meaning of § 3a V 1,2 UStG or a legal person under public law that is not an entrepreneur within the meaning of § 3a V 3 UStG (§19 I 2 UstG): "Reverse Charge - die Steuer wird vom Leistungempfänger geschuldet." • Local reverse charge for immovable property (§19 Ia UStG): "Reverse Charge - Die Steuer für Bauleistung wird vom Leistungsempfänger geschuldet" • Reverse Charge for deliveries in the sense of §19 Ib lit. a-c UStG if the receiver is an entrepreneur or a public entity of public law. • Reverse charge in the cases of services of an EU resident entrepreneur to an Austrian recipient §§19 Ic – Ie UStG • Intracommunity supplies (§ 6 I UStG in Connection with §7 I UStG): "steuerfreie innergemeinschaftliche Lieferung" • Transfer of goods within the European Union (§6 I Nr.1 UStG in Connection with §7 I UStG):"steuerfreie innergemeinschaftliche Verbringung" • Simplified triangular sales) (§25 UStG): "Dreiecksgeschäft gemäß Art. 197 (1) a) System Mehrwertsteuer-Richtlinie 2006/112/EC, die Steuer wird vom Leistungsempfänger geschuldet" • Exports (§7 UStG): "steuerfreie Ausfuhrlieferung" - B2B main rule (Art. 44 VAT Directive - VAT reversed to the Country of customer (sect. 3a par. 6 VAT Act): "Leistungsort am Sitz des Leistungsempfängers"
Allowed to refer to the appropriate provision in Directive 2006/112/EC for: - "reverse charge" for supplies subject to a reverse charge mechanism; - " supply is taxable in the country of the recipient" for B2B supplies of services; - "exempt intra-Community supply - article 138 VAT Directive"; - "Exempt export - article 146 VAT Directive"; - "simplification for triangular sales - article 141 VAT Directive - " Transfer of own goods- article 17 VAT Directive"?	• Yes

Required to specifically mention 'margin scheme - travel agencies', 'margin scheme - second hands goods', if applicable	• Yes
Reference required if the transaction takes place outside the EU as a result of the Use and enjoyment provisions	• No
Specific other reference required, e.g. in case of barter transaction, prepayments, etc. (not self-billing or special margin schemes)	• No
Specific references required in case invoicing is outsourced	• There is no specific wording necessary. Please consider that the identity of the third party has to be guaranteed. The invoice should not make it appear as if the third party is the provider of the service. In this case, there is the risk that the third party is the debtor of the VAT (too).
Reference to 'cash accounting scheme' in B2B sales in case the IT is due by the supplier upon receipt of the payment/IT is deductible by the customer upon payment	• No
Other specific requirements/references to be mentioned on an invoice	• No

6.5. Simplified invoice

The Supplier is not always obliged to issue a complete invoice. In certain scenarios, they may be able to issue a so-called simplified invoice.

Simplified invoicing	
Possible to issue simplified invoices for certain supplies	• B2B: Yes (§11 VI UStG)
Maximum amount for simplified invoices	• B2B: EUR 400,00 (§11 VI UStG)
Other supplies for which a simplified invoice can be issued	• No
Simplified invoices limited to certain type of supplies	• Yes, no simplified invoice to federal offices (§4 I e-Rechnungsverordnung)
Simplified invoices not allowed for certain transactions	• No

Minimum content requirements on a simplified invoice	• Full legal name and full address of the supplier (§11 VI Nr.1 UStG) • Quantity of the goods/services (§11 VI Nr.2 UStG) • Description of the goods/Services (§11 VI Nr.2 UStG) • Date of supply/service (§11 VI Nr.3 UStG) • The remuneration and the tax amount for the supply/service in one sum (§11 VI Nr.4 UStG) • Tax rate (§11 VI Nr.5 UStG)
Invoices subject to the national invoice requirements (not self-bills)	• Invoices issued by a non-established supplier on which IT is due by the supplier • Invoices issued by an established supplier that are taxable in another country but where IT is due by the customer • Invoices issued by an established supplier that are taxable in our country
(other) Invoices subject to the national invoice requirements (not self-bills)	• No

Pagero Online does not support the creation of simplified invoices as they typically do not correspond to the business requirements of Buyers.

6.6. Rectification document

In Austria, credit/debit note must be issued as rectification documents. A credit/debit should include at least the following information:

Specific references for rectification documents	
Must the word "credit note" be mentioned	• Yes
Reference to original invoice required on a credit note	• Invoice number
Clear indication required that the amount mentioned on the credit note is crediting earlier amount (e.g. minus sign '-')	• No • From the credit note must result that a credit is invoiced, e.g. the reference 'credit note' must be mentioned on the document
Reason for credit required	• No, but recommended

Sequential numbering	
Separate sequential credit note numbering required	• No • The Austrian VAT Act does not provide the sequential numbering of credit notes to be separate from the sequential invoice numbering for regular invoices. It is sufficient for the purposes of the Austrian VAT Act that credit notes dispose of a unique number or are numbered within the sequential range for regular invoices.
Allowed to issue one credit note to correct different invoices	• Yes • Reference to the respective invoices (invoice number)

Pagero Online creates corrective invoices according to the content requirements of the Complete invoice.

6.7. Optional content

This section outlines briefly whether and how the trading parties can provide additional content in the technical e-document format mandated or otherwise prescribed in the specific jurisdiction.

No additional content in Austria.

7. Integrity and Authenticity

Ensuring the integrity of the content, as well as the authenticity of the origin (I&A) of an invoice, is an obligation for both the Supplier and the Recipient.

The purpose of this section is to further clarify the local I&A requirements on B2B invoices, as well as outline whether different requirements apply to B2G invoices. The review is done both from the Supplier's and the Recipient's perspective, as varying rules may apply.

Item	Supplier	Recipient
Whether it is mandatory to ensure I&A in the jurisdiction	• Mandatory (§11 II 3 UStG)	• Mandatory (§11 II 3 UStG)
Which methods for ensuring I&A are provisioned for	• E-signature, EDI, or internal control procedures that provide a reliable audit trail between invoice and performance	• E-signature validation, EDI or internal control procedures that provide a reliable audit trail between invoice and performance
Which requirements apply for I&A methods if ensured by a third-party (outsourcing)	• No explicit requirements, but an explicit agreement is strongly recommended	• No explicit requirements, but an explicit agreement is strongly recommended

7.1. e-Signature

Even where e-signature is not an explicit requirement, Pagero recommends that our customers apply it as, globally, it is the most widely accepted legal means of ensuring I&A for business transactions.

In practical terms, this results in the same evidential position for eDocuments as for paper documents. This unique feature of e-signature provides an exceptional level of legal certainty.

Item	Commentary
e-Signature technical requirements	• QES meeting certain requirements (Art. 28 in conjunction with Annex I eIDAS-VO)

Automated e-signing	• No explicit requirements
Time-stamping of e-signature	• No explicit requirements

7.2. e-Signature validation

The Recipient of an invoice is often required by law or practice to validate the e-signature on the received invoice. Even for countries where the validation-upon-receipt is not expressly regulated, this is recommended by Pagero for both trading partners to be able to guarantee I&A.

Item	Commentary
Validation upon receipt	• No explicit requirements
Time-stamping of validation data	• No explicit requirements

8. Document retention

This section describes archiving requirements regarding the eInvoicing process and documents handled by Pagero. Please note, additional archiving requirements may apply to your specific documents.

Item	Commentary
Components to be stored (e.g. tax invoice, source documents, audit trail, I&A proof)	• Original invoice with signature including certificate or other evidence of integrity and authenticity as appropriate
Requirements to present stored documents in a specific audit format	• No requirements for capabilities to transform to audit format
Legibility, i.e. the ability to read stored e-documents by an untrained eye	• Required (§132 III BAO)
Legibility requirements	• If the original invoice is in a machine-readable format, the taxable person must offer means to provide human readability (§132 III BAO)
Retention period for invoices not related to immovable property[8]	• 7 years (§212 I UBG)
Start point of retention period calculation for invoices not related to immovable property	• From 1 January following the date of the invoice and in pending cases till the end of the case (§212 II UBG)
Retention period for e- invoices related to immovable property	• 22 years (12 years in some "old" cases) (§18 X UStG)
Start point of retention period calculation for invoices related to immovable property	• From 1 January following the date of the invoice and in pending cases till the end of the case
Retention period for other than regular invoices or invoices related to immovable property (if existing):	• The Austrian Value Added Tax Act stipulates an additional retention period for documents relating to electronically provided services, telecommunications, radio and television services provided to

[8] Pagero stores all documents for 90 days due to data privacy and security regulations, after which the data is automatically deleted, unless Archive has been selected. Pagero provides long term archiving (for the legally required term, plus one year)

	non-entrepreneurs in EU member states and for which the new Mini-One-Stop-Shop (MOSS) is used; here the retention period is 10 years.
Start point of retention period calculation for other than regular invoices or invoices related to immovable property:	• From 1 January following the date of the invoice and in pending cases till the end of the case
Outsourced archiving	• Allowed
Archiving abroad[9] and conditions, if any (e.g. notification, derogation, online access, mutual tax assistance treaty	• Permitted in EU: subject to prior notification and online access • Outside of EU: additionally, subject to the existence of a mutual tax assistance treaty or a treaty to ensure online access, download and usage of all tax relevant data
Other requirements in relation to electronic document retention	• Invoices must be printable from the archive upon request (§132 II, III BAO)

[9] In certain situations or jurisdictions deviating requirements – typically regarding archiving abroad – may apply to invoices and related documents, e.g. concerning matters of defence and national security. Therefore, Pagero encourages customers to inquire for and receive an explicit written statement from the local tax authority stating that the archiving of such documents outside of the taxpayer's country is permitted. Pagero in a capacity of a third-party may not apply for derogations or clarifications of this nature on behalf of a taxpayer.

9. Other transactional documents

Along with invoices, countries may have regulations relating to other trading documents. The purpose of this section is to provide a selective (not exhaustive) overview of the regulation of other transaction-related documents of importance.

Document	Commentary
Purchase order	• No explicit requirements
Rectification document	• Yes, see section 6.6 above
Payment instruction	• No explicit requirements
SAF-T (or alike) reporting	• SAF-T applicable but in practice case by case, upon request, see section 10.2 • For cash transactions, obligation approval invoice since April 1, 2017
Transportation documents	• No explicit requirements
Other	• N.a.

10. Other requirements

This section highlights certain aspects of the local regulations and infrastructure that differ from Pagero's General invoice processing and our standard country compliance investigation.

10.1. Public procurement

The Federal Procurement Act of 2018 regulates the awarding of public contracts in Austria. The Bundesbeschaffung GmbH (BBG) is the federal public procurement agency from Austria. The BBG invoices portal is connected to the federal government eInvoicing service. The The BBG organizes the purchases of the federal government, cities and municipalities.

The BBG becomes relevant when the order volume exceeds 100,000 euros. Then you have to put it out to public tender. There is, where BBG intervenes and overtakes the tendering procedures. The contracts of the BBG are based on tendering procedures which are carried out on the basis of the Federal Public Procurement Act. The BBG offers orders, the best bidder principle, fair competition and legal certainty. However, the BBG strives for the largest possible bidder landscape and offers understandable documents and full support. Therefore, BBG provides an E-Procurement solution. Within this solution is also an opportunity to use the e-invoicing service of BBG. The E-Shop serves as an ordering tool.

Who can become a customer of BBG?

Public services/bodies whose tasks are in the general interest, and which are not profit-making, including

- States

- Towns and municipalities
- Outsourced federal, state or local institutions
- Universities
- Healthcare organization

Who is required to connect to BBG?

According to the BBG Act, all federal departments are obliged to place orders via federal procurement. (§4 I, II 1 BB-GmbH-Gesetz)

- Exceptions (§4 II 2 Nr.1-3 BB-GmbH-Gesetz)
    - immediate, unforeseeable, necessary needs
    - third-party provides the same services cheaper
    - at least 50% of the company is privately subsidized

Who can connect voluntarily to BBG?

Everyone, especially small entrepreneurs and medium sized companies are encouraged to take part on the tendering process.

How can you connect to BBG?

click on the "login icon" in the status bar in the upper right corner. Then click on "I am new here" and fill out the required fields. An e-mail will be sent after completing the registration. After receiving click on the link to confirm your e-mail address. The registration for the portal is now complete. Make sure that the email address you entered has been validated. Only after clicking on the link, which was sent, a registration for the portal is possible.

Relationship with USP?

“According to the law, the BBG as a purchasing service provider of the federal government is intended to carry out bundled purchasing for all federal agencies. We would like to offer you the possibility to send us all your invoices in a centralized way and we will then send them to the appropriate offices”

Contractual partners who also have a contract with BBG are, for technical reasons, additionally managed in the ordering party system with a so-called ES vendor number (e.g. ES99999999). In any case, this vendor number is unique and is to be used with priority for e-invoicing to the Federal Government, regardless of whether the order was placed through the BBG or not.

Special fields for invoices relating to BBG contracts have to be converted in the different formats. The special BBG data are:

- BBG partner number of the biller
- BBG partner number of the invoice recipient
- BBG transaction number (contract number) at header and/or item level

The connection is as follows: if an order is placed based on a framework agreement concluded with BBG, the invoice must be transferred via BBG. The BBG then takes care of the forwarding of the invoice to eRechnung.gv.at.

If the Federal Government supplier is NOT commissioned via the BBG, the invoice can be sent directly to eRechnung.gv.at.

Which formats are processed by BBG?

In the case of sending to the customer

- PDF (most common format)
- SAP iDoc
- UBL 2.0

In the case of accounting via interface

- ebInterface 4.3
- ebInterface 5.0
- ebInterface 6.0
- ebinterface 6.1
- UBL 2.1
- UBL 2.0
- SAP iDoc
- ebUtilities (only invoices for energy)
- CII

Which ways of transmission are possible?

- E-Mail (Sending to a chosen e-mail address)
- SFTP (Storage on your FTP server)
- SOAP (Transmission via Webservice)
- PRINT (in paper form via post)

E-Mail adresses where invoices are sent to

- clearingcenter@dig.at

- dsn@erelation.at

E-invoicing process

- Variant 1 is the form-based creation of the e-bill in the BBG e-Shop. Here the BBG supplier can create an e-invoice based on their e-shop orders or create an invoice without order reference, which will be sent to BBG customers.

- Variant 2 enables structured invoice delivery from ERP system of the BBG supplier. Various transport routes (e.g. sFTP, Web Service) and formats (e.g. ebInterface, UBL) are available. After delivery, the BBG e-bill gateway takes over the technical format check and the check for mandatory fields (e.g. according to UStG, e-bill regulation)

  In case of an error, a corresponding error message is reported back. If the e-bill is error-free, it will be sent to the corresponding invoice recipient (customers of BBG). A distinction is made between federal and third-party customers. Bills

  to federal customers are forwarded to the Corporate Service Portal (USP) in accordance with legal requirements. Invoices to third party customers are forwarded to them in the desired format. The e-bill gateway handles the data formatting.

10.2. Indirect tax reports

The Standard Audit File for Tax (SAF-T) was developed by the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) with the aim of producing a standardised format for electronic exchange of accounting data from organisations to their national tax authority and external auditors.

The two key principles of SAF-T are:

1) Organisations should be able to export information from their accounting systems (invoices etc.) into a standardised format
2) Tax authorities and external auditors should be able to make their tax inspections and audits more efficient and effective as a result of data being made available to them in that standardised format.

Austria introduced the Standard Audit File for Tax (SAF-T) on 31 January 2009. At present Austrian SAF-T is only required on-demand by the tax authorities, usually prior to a VAT audit by the Austrian Federal Ministry for finances (de. Bundesministerium für Finanzen).

10.3. List of central contracting authorities

- Federal Chancellery
- Federal Ministry of Public Service and Sports
- Federal Ministry for Europe, Integration and Foreign Affairs
- Federal Ministry of Labor, Social Affairs, Health and Consumer Protection
- Federal Ministry of Education, Science and Research
- Federal Ministry for Digitization and Business Location
- Federal Ministry of Finance
- federal Ministry of Internal Affairs
- Federal Ministry of Defence **)
- Federal Ministry of Sustainability and Tourism
- Federal Ministry for Constitution, Reforms, Deregulation and Justice
- Federal Ministry of Transport, Innovation and Technology
- AIT Austrian Institute of Technology GmbH
- Federal Procurement Ges. Mb H.
- Federal Computing Centre Ges. Mb H

10.4. Use of CIUS at national level

Austria has two CIUS's in place: one for the national level (complying with Austrian VAT law) and another one for the government sector's specific obligations (based on the previous CIUS on VAT law). These two CIUSs are approved by the Federal Minister of Finance.

10.5. Penalties

E-invoicing is not mandatory in the B2B nor B2C sectors. Therefore, there is currently no penalties. E-invoicing is mandatory in the B2G sector. Not known penalties in the B2G sector, other than inability to bill the buyer.

11. Country-specific processing

This section outlines how the Pagero General eInvoicing process has been adapted to the local requirements to ensure compliant local processing.

11.1. B2G Document issuance (AR) with Pagero

Central Government

(1) Supplier provides data in supplier preferred format to PAGERO
(2) PAGERO performs i.a.
    a. content validation,
    b. content enrichment and conversion,
    c. document format conversion, etc.
(3) PAGERO returns the finalized e-invoice to the supplier
(4) PAGERO sends the final e-document to USP via Peppol AS4 protocol in Peppol Bis format
(5) USP sends the received e-document to the Central Government in the buyer's format

(6-8) Return communication from the buyer to the supplier, i.a. receipt acknowledgement, document approval or rejection, which could be optional or mandatory

(9) PAGERO archives all relevant document on behalf of the supplier

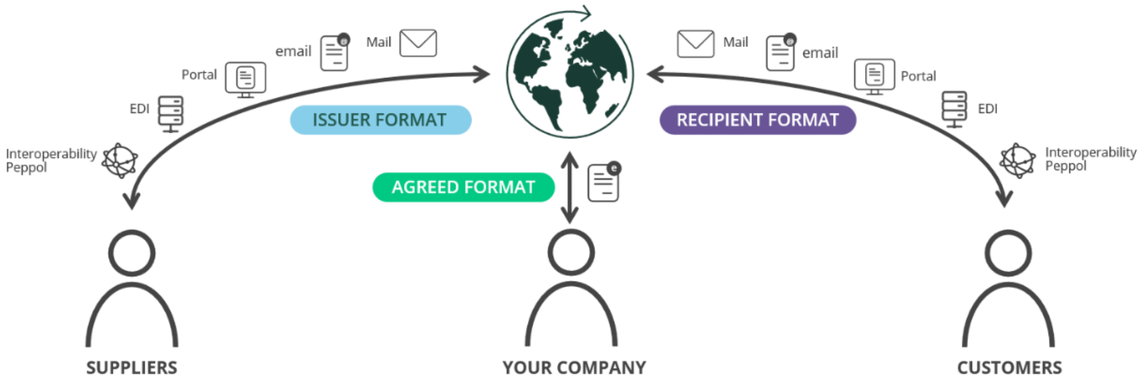
Sub-Central Government

(1) Supplier provides data in supplier preferred format to PAGERO
(2) PAGERO performs i.a.
    a. content validation,
    b. content enrichment and conversion,
    c. document format conversion, etc.
(3) PAGERO returns the finalized e-invoice to the supplier
(4) PAGERO sends the final e-document to BBG via SFTP in BBG Austria UBL 2.1 format
(5) BBG sends the received e-document to the Sub-Central Government in the buyer's format

(6-8) Return communication from the Sub-Central Government to the supplier, i.a. receipt acknowledgement, document approval or rejection, which could be optional or mandatory

(9) PAGERO archives all relevant document on behalf of the supplier

11.2. B2B Document issuance and reception (AR and AP) with Pagero



(1) PAGERO ensures that documents can be exchanged with your company and your suppliers and customers, from your company perspective in a single format to ensure 100% digital AR and AP processing, while on the other hand in the preferred format and exchange mechanism with your trading partners
(2) PAGERO ensures the country-specific document content, document integrity and authenticity, as well as archiving requirements
(3) PAGERO supports unlimited number of document formats and multiple exchange mechanisms
(4) PAGERO supports such exchange channels as: Interoperability, Peppol, EDI, portal, e-mail, capturing / scanning, etc.

12. Closing statements

12.1. Confidentiality

This General invoice processing description of Pagero Online, our Country Compliance Reports, and other documents provided by Pagero are of confidential nature and are only intended for and may only be used by Pagero's Customers, their employees or other authorized recipients for the purpose or purposes specified and agreed to between the parties. Descriptions, reports, and documentation may not – neither in full nor in parts – be copied or otherwise distributed to third parties without Pagero's prior written consent.

12.2. Disclaimer

In order to establish a relationship based on trust and transparency with our Customers, Pagero provides its General e-Invoice and eArchiving processing descriptions of Pagero Online as well as Pagero's Country Compliance Reports. These documents are intended to enable our Customers and their tax advisors to assess how Pagero has interpreted the relevant legislation and implemented it in our processes in order to support our Customers to fulfil their legal obligations.

We would like to remind our Customers that, according to tax and accounting regulations, the outsourcing of any process to third parties (such as issuance, compiling, processing, receipt, or archiving of e-Invoices), will not lead to a shift of liability, the liability will remain with the Customer. Accordingly, the taxable person always remains responsible towards the local authorities for ensuring their e-Invoice compliance, and for fulfilling accounting and reporting requirements. We want to emphasise this, in the light of that there can be potentially conflicting regulations on regional, national, or international levels.

Pagero endeavours to only include and provide accurate and up to date information. However, Pagero makes no guarantees as to the accuracy of any statement, information or advice provided by Pagero, whether in writing or verbally. The Customer must make an informed decision about whether to adhere to and follow such recommendations or not. The final decision and responsibility regarding tax, accounting, and reporting issues rest with the Customer.

Revision history

Date	What has changed
28 November 2017	Document created
17 January 2019	Update of legislation WRT ePro Dir.
03 December 2019	Update section 6.3 VAT rate on electronic publications (10%)
25 September 2020	Multiple minor updates and additions
27 January 2023	Section 5.1: updated format and other technical requirements Section 10.1: Public procurement (BBG) Section 11.1: Illustration (BBG)
27 July 2023	Section 10.5: Penalties